

Basic Functions of Emotions



FEAR

The main function is to keep us safe by urging us to escape from dangerous situations by running away, avoiding, or hiding.

ANGER

Prepares us to fight in a situation of assault or loss of important people, things and goals.



DISGUST

The main function is to keep contamination away from us. It urges us to get rid of whatever we find disgusting, e.g., rotten food, poison, etc.

ENVY

The function is to motivate us to work hard to get what others have and we do not. The problem with envy is that - at times it becomes corrosive of the mind and spirit and therefore does little good to us. Bitterness is a common outcome of envy.

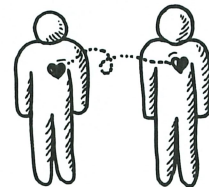


JEALOUSY

Urges us to action if someone is threatening to take away an important relationship or thing from us. Often when we are jealous we try to control the actions of people we are afraid to lose, or we refuse to share what we have with others.

LOVE

Motivates us to find, be with, attach ourselves to the other person. On the level of the society, it motivates our reproduction.



SADNESS

Pulls us into ourselves so that we can figure out what is really important to us and what to do when we have lost something/somebody very important. It also signals to others that we need help.

SHAME

Prompts us to hide/not to engage in behaviours that could cause rejection from others. Shame is a very culturally driven emotion, depends on moral standards in particular places/communities/subcultures.



GUILT

Motivates us to repair/compensate if we did something wrong to others. It also prevents us from doing wrong things again.

HAPPINESS

Aids our survival by making us more attuned to our environment, more social, more energetic, fitter, kinder, and more optimistic. It is also frequently contagious and makes other people feel happy!

